DYSEKT

USER MANUAL · FREE · OPEN SOURCE · VST3 SAMPLE SLICER FOR WINDOWS

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What Is Dysekt?

Dysekt is a sample slicer VST3 plugin for Windows. You load an audio file, cut it into up to **32 slices**, and trigger those slices over MIDI — live, in a DAW, or both at the same time.

The 32-slice cap is intentional. Most samplers offer hundreds of options and you end up managing instead of making music. Dysekt draws the line at 32 and gets out of your way.

Three views cover three parts of the job:

- **Edit View** — load, trim, and slice your sample; set per-slice parameters
- **Pad View** — play and audition slices on a 16-pad grid
- **Mixer View** — route and balance all 32 slices at once

Installation

1. Download the latest release `.vst3` file from the GitHub Releases page.
2. Copy it to your VST3 folder — usually:

```
C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3
```

3. Rescan plugins in your DAW.
4. Insert Dysekt on a MIDI instrument track.

Requirements: Windows · 64-bit DAW with VST3 support.

First Launch

When you open Dysekt for the first time, the **built-in file browser** opens automatically so you can pick a sample straight away. Navigate to any audio file and click it to load.

Once a sample is loaded, the browser closes and Edit View takes over.

Loading a Sample

There are two ways to load a sample after first launch:

Drag and Drop

Drag any audio file from your OS or DAW directly onto the Dysekt window. Dysekt accepts:

`.wav` `.aif` `.aiff` `.ogg` `.flac` `.mp3`

Built-In Browser

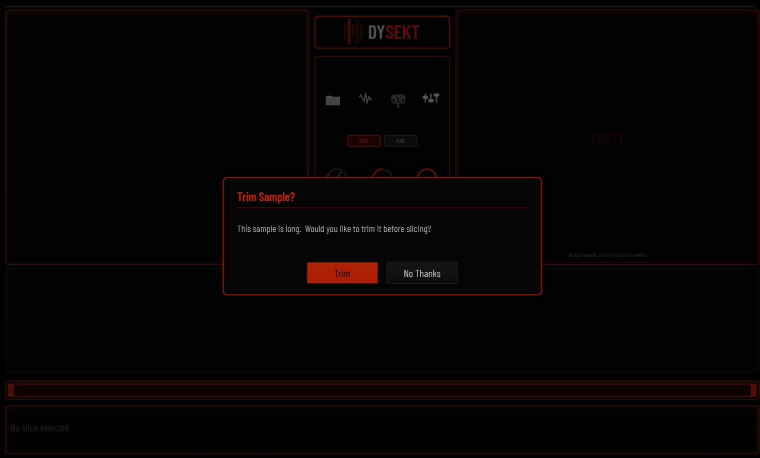
Click the **browser button** in the header bar to open the file browser panel. Navigate your drive, click a file, and it loads.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You have a 16-bar drum loop in your samples folder. Open the browser, find `drum_loop_140bpm.wav`, click it — Dysekt asks if you want to trim it first, you click No Thanks, and the waveform appears in Edit View.

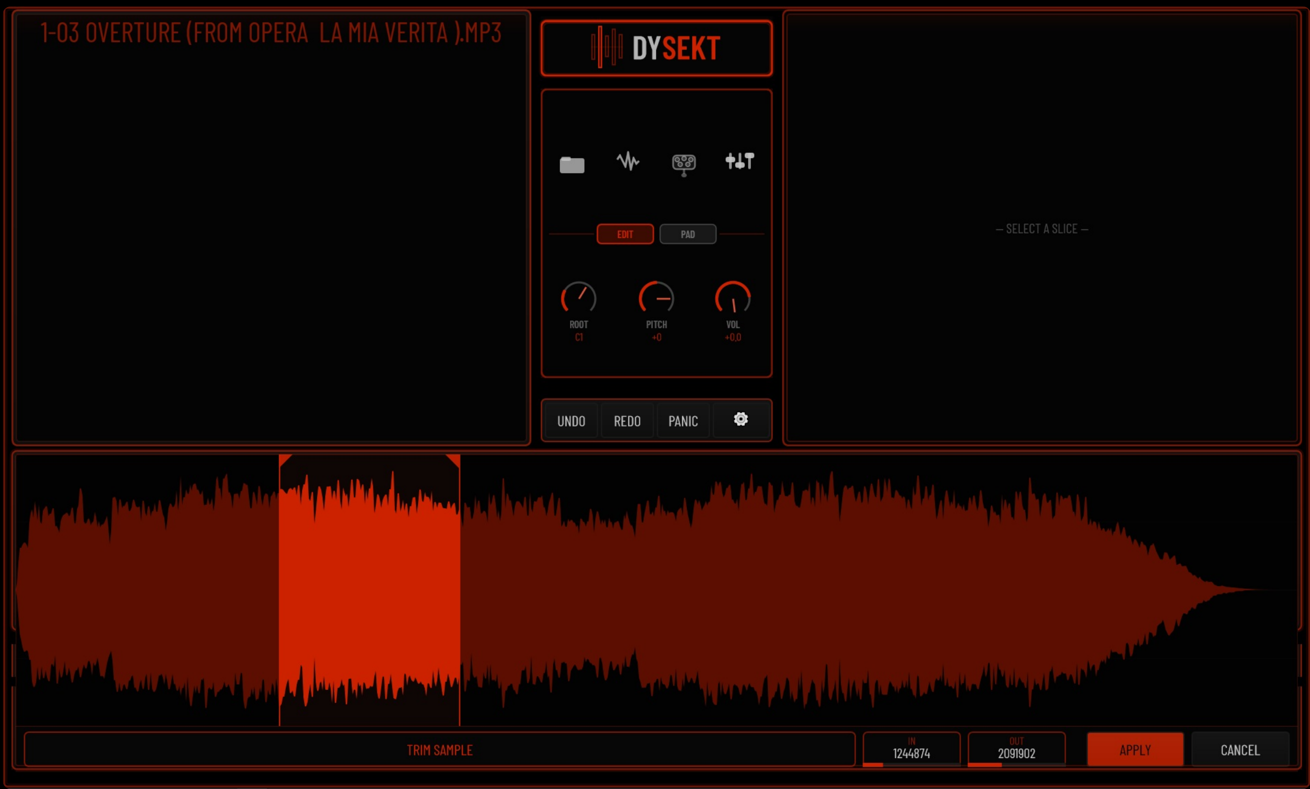
The Trim Dialog

When you load a sample that is **longer than about 5 seconds**, Dysekt pops up a confirmation:

> *"This sample is long. Would you like to trim it before slicing?"*



- **Trim** — Opens Trim Mode. The waveform switches to trim view. Drag the **In** and **Out** handles to define the region you want to keep. Click **Apply** to crop the sample to that region. All existing slices are cleared and the trimmed audio becomes your new sample.
- **No Thanks** — Loads the full sample as-is.



> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You loaded a 10-minute live recording but only want bars 32–48. Click Trim, drag the handles to that region, click Apply. Now you're only working with that portion.

> **TIP**
>
> You can set a preference in your DAW session to always trim, never trim, or always ask — so you stop seeing the dialog if you always say No Thanks.

The Three Views

Switch between views using the **EDIT** and **PAD** tabs in the center header, and the **mixer button** on the right side of the header.

Edit View

The main working view — where you spend most of your time. Layout from top to bottom:

- **Slice LCD** (top left) — name, MIDI note, and key parameters of the selected slice
- **Center Control Frame** — EDIT/PAD tab switcher plus transport controls
- **Slice Waveform LCD** (top right) — zoomed waveform of just the selected slice, with draggable ADSR envelope nodes overlaid. Drag the attack, decay, sustain, and release nodes directly on this display.
- **Action Panel** — a row of slice operation buttons (MIDI Slice, Auto Slice, Trim, etc.)
- **Waveform View** — the full sample waveform with color-coded slice regions. Click and drag here to create and move slices.
- **Waveform Overview / Zoom Bar** — a thumbnail of the full sample below the main waveform, showing the current viewport. Click and drag it to scroll.
- **Slice Control Bar (SCB)** — ADSR, pitch, filter, pan, BPM, mute group, output bus, and more for the selected slice.

Pad View

Switch with the **PAD** tab. 16 color-coded pads — Bank A (slices 1–16) and Bank B (slices 17–32). Every pad shows its slice's waveform thumbnail and lights up on playback. Pad colors match the slice colors in Edit View.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You've got a drum break with 8 slices. Switch to Pad View and jam the pads in real time — kick on one pad, snare on another, hi-hat on the next. It feels like a drum machine because it is one.

Mixer View

Click the **mixer button** (labeled BODE in the header) to open Mixer View. All 32 slices appear as vertical channel strips. Each strip has a level fader, pan knob, Mute, Solo, and an output bus selector. Strip headers are color-coded to match Edit and Pad Views.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You want your kick on Output 1, your snare on Output 2, everything else on the main out. Open Mixer View, find the kick strip, set its bus to 1, find the snare, set it to 2. Done in seconds.

Slicing Your Sample

Once a sample is loaded, you have several ways to cut it into slices.

MIDI Slice — Live MIDI Slicing

The signature feature. Press `L` (or the MIDI Slice button in the Action Panel) to start playback of the entire sample. As it plays, **hit any MIDI note** to place a slice boundary at that exact moment.

Each note hit drops a new slice marker at the playhead position. Keep hitting notes as the sample plays. Press `L` again to stop — the sample stops and your slice markers are set.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You've loaded a 4-bar drum break. Press L — the sample starts playing. You hit a pad every time you hear the kick land. After a full pass you have 8 slices placed right on the transients — no menu diving, just feel.

> **TIP**
>
> Snap to zero-crossing is always active in MIDI Slice, so your markers land on clean audio boundaries — no clicks or pops.

Auto Slice

Right click on the sample and select Auto Slice. Choose between 4,8,16 or 32 slices. Dysekt instantly divides the sample into that many evenly-spaced slices.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You want 16 equal slices on a 2-bar loop. Click Auto Slice, enter 16, done. Use this as a starting point and nudge the markers from there.

Manual Slicing

In Edit View, **click anywhere on the waveform** to place a new slice marker at that position. The marker snaps to the nearest zero crossing.

Deleting and Adjusting Slices

- **Move a marker:** Click and drag any slice boundary line in the waveform.
- **Delete by dragging:** Drag a marker left until it overlaps the previous marker — when you release, the slice is deleted.
- **Delete selected:** Press `Delete`.
- **Right-click a slice** in the waveform for options including Delete Slice and Rename Slice.

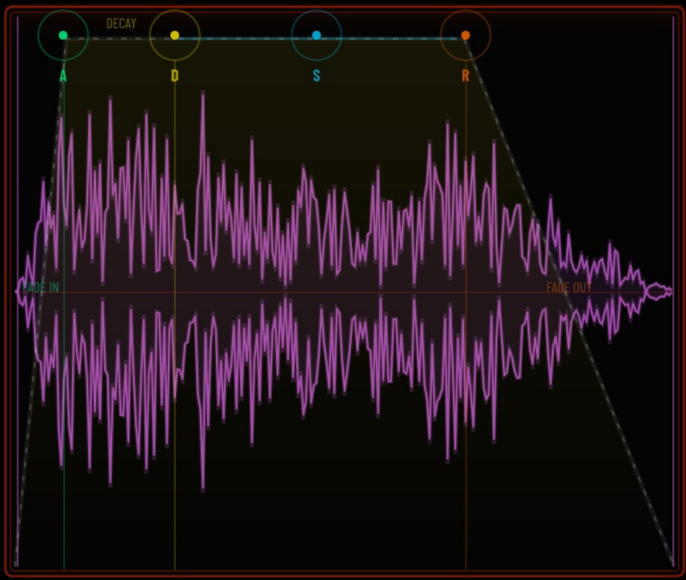
Per-Slice Controls

Select any slice (click it in the waveform, or press arrow keys) and the **Slice Control Bar (SCB)** at the bottom of Edit View shows its parameters.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Attack / Decay / Sustain / Release	Envelope shape — how the slice fades in and out
Pitch	Transpose in semitones (±48)
Cents Detune	Fine-tune in cents (±100)
Gain / Volume	Per-slice level in dB
Pan	Left/right position
Filter Cutoff / Resonance	Low-pass filter cutoff and resonance
Mute Group	Slices in the same group cut each other off
Output Bus	Route this slice to a specific stereo output
MIDI Note	Which MIDI note triggers this slice
Loop Mode	Off, Loop, Ping-pong
One Shot	Slice plays to the end regardless of note-off
Reverse	Play the slice backwards

Release Tail	Let the audio ring out after note-off
Chromatic Channel	Assign a MIDI channel for chromatic playback
Legato	Smooth pitch transitions on chromatic slices

The **ADSR Envelope Visualizer** in the Slice Waveform LCD (top right) shows the envelope shape live. Drag the nodes on that display for hands-on shaping.



Locking a Parameter

Parameters in the SCB have a small **lock icon**. When unlocked, the parameter follows the global default. Lock it to pin a value to that slice — it won't change when you adjust the global default.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You want every slice to use the global reverb tail except slice 3 which should cut short. Set slice 3's Release to 5ms and lock it. Now when you adjust the global Release, slice 3 stays dry and punchy.

Playback Modes

Set per-slice in the SCB:

- **Normal** — plays the slice and stops on note-off (or at the end)
- **One Shot** — ignores note-off, plays all the way to the end
- **Loop** — loops the slice while the key is held
- **Reverse** — plays the slice backwards

Chromatic Mode

By default each slice is triggered by one specific MIDI note. **Chromatic Mode** lets you play a slice melodically across the entire keyboard, like an instrument.

Setting It Up

1. Select the slice you want to play chromatically.
2. In the SCB, set **Chromatic Channel** to any MIDI channel (1–16).
3. Any MIDI note arriving on that channel now triggers that slice, pitched relative to the root note.

Notes above the root play the slice up in pitch; notes below play it down. The root note is set globally in the center control area.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You have a bass hit on slice 4. Set its Chromatic Channel to 3. Your other slices on channels 1 and 2 play as drums normally, and slice 4 on channel 3 becomes a playable bass instrument. One plugin — drums and bass.

Legato

Enable **Legato** on a chromatic slice for smooth pitch transitions — when you play a new note before releasing the old one, the pitch glides without restarting the sample. Playback position is preserved.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> Set Legato on a pad or string slice. Hold a note and play another before releasing — the sample keeps playing and smoothly shifts pitch, giving you a real legato phrase.

Unsliced Chromatic Playback

Before you add any slices — or while Trim Mode is open — the whole sample plays **chromatically from C3**. Every MIDI note plays the sample at a different pitch, with C3 at the original pitch.

This lets you audition a sample melodically before committing to any slicing. Dysekt always makes sound from the moment you load something.

MIDI Follow

When MIDI Follow is on, the waveform view scrolls automatically to show whichever slice is currently being triggered by MIDI. The selected slice in the UI tracks the live performance.

Toggle: Press `F`, or click the MIDI Follow button in the header bar.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You're playing a beat and want to watch the waveform scroll to each hit as it fires. Turn on MIDI Follow and the display tracks your performance in real time.

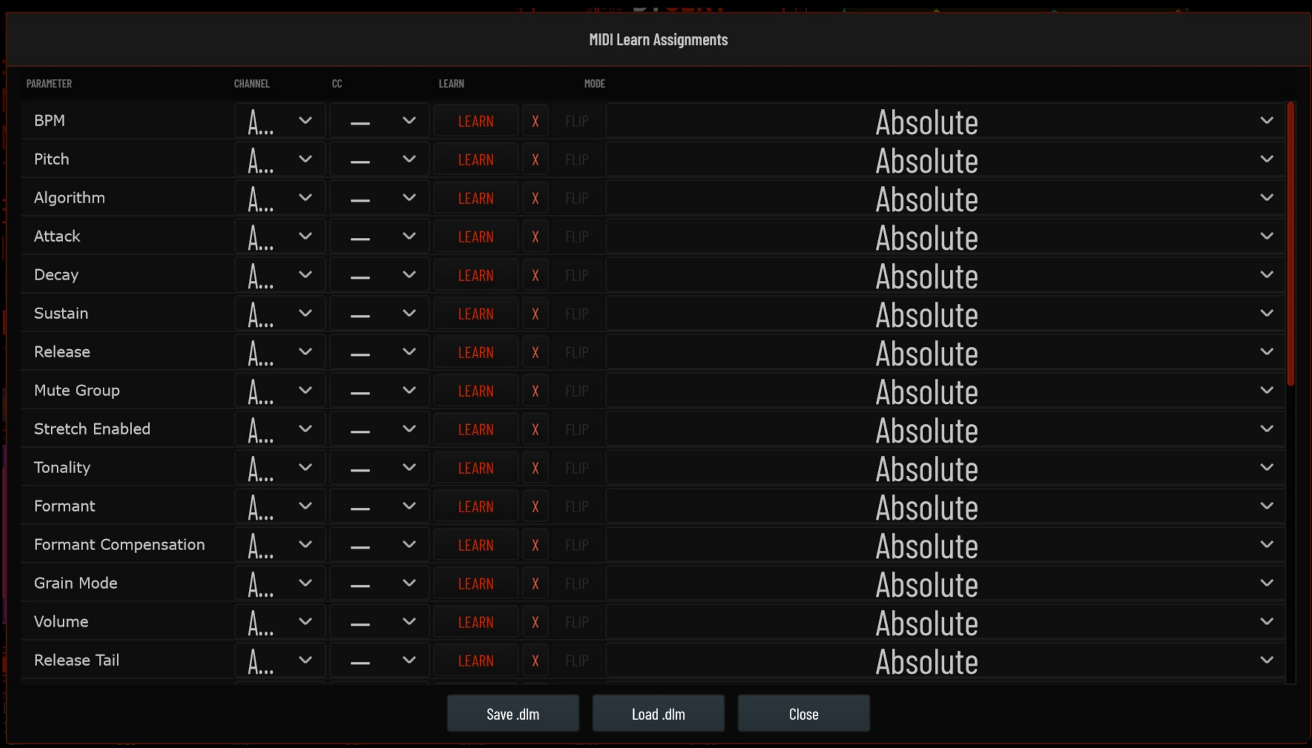
> **TIP**
>
> MIDI Follow turns on automatically the first time you add slices to a sample.

MIDI Learn

Right-click **any knob or parameter** in the SCB and choose **MIDI Learn**. Move a knob or fader on your hardware controller and it's mapped.

Press `M` (or click the MIDI icon in the header) to open the full **MIDI Learn dialog**. Here you can:

- See all current mappings
- Assign CC numbers manually
- Choose **absolute** or **relative** (endless encoder) mode
- Save and recall your mapping set



Pickup Mode

For absolute CC controllers, Dysekt uses pickup mode to prevent parameter jumps. When you switch to a different slice, the knob won't affect it until it physically passes through the current value — no sudden jumps.

You can also map **zoom** and **scroll** of the waveform to CC controls.

Waveform Navigation — Zoom and Scroll

- **Scroll wheel** over the waveform to zoom in and out.
- **Click and drag** on the **Waveform Overview** strip below the main waveform to scroll to any position.
- The overview shows a white viewport indicator — drag it, or click elsewhere on the overview, to jump instantly.

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> You have a long sample and fine-tuned slices in the first bar. Zoom in to check those markers, then click the

> right half of the overview bar to jump to bar 2 instantly.

The Built-In File Browser

Click the **browser button** in the header bar to toggle the file browser panel. The browser replaces the waveform area while it's open.

Navigate your drive, preview files by clicking on them, and load them by double-clicking or clicking the load button. The browser closes automatically once a file is loaded.

> **NOTE**
> The browser and Mixer View are mutually exclusive — opening one closes the other.

Themes and UI Scale

Themes

Dysekt ships with nine built-in themes:

`dark` `shell` `lazy` `snow` `ghost` `hack` `midnight` `pigments` `dysekt`

Access themes from the **Shortcuts Panel** (press `?`). A button inside opens the **Theme Editor** directly. In the Theme Editor you can:

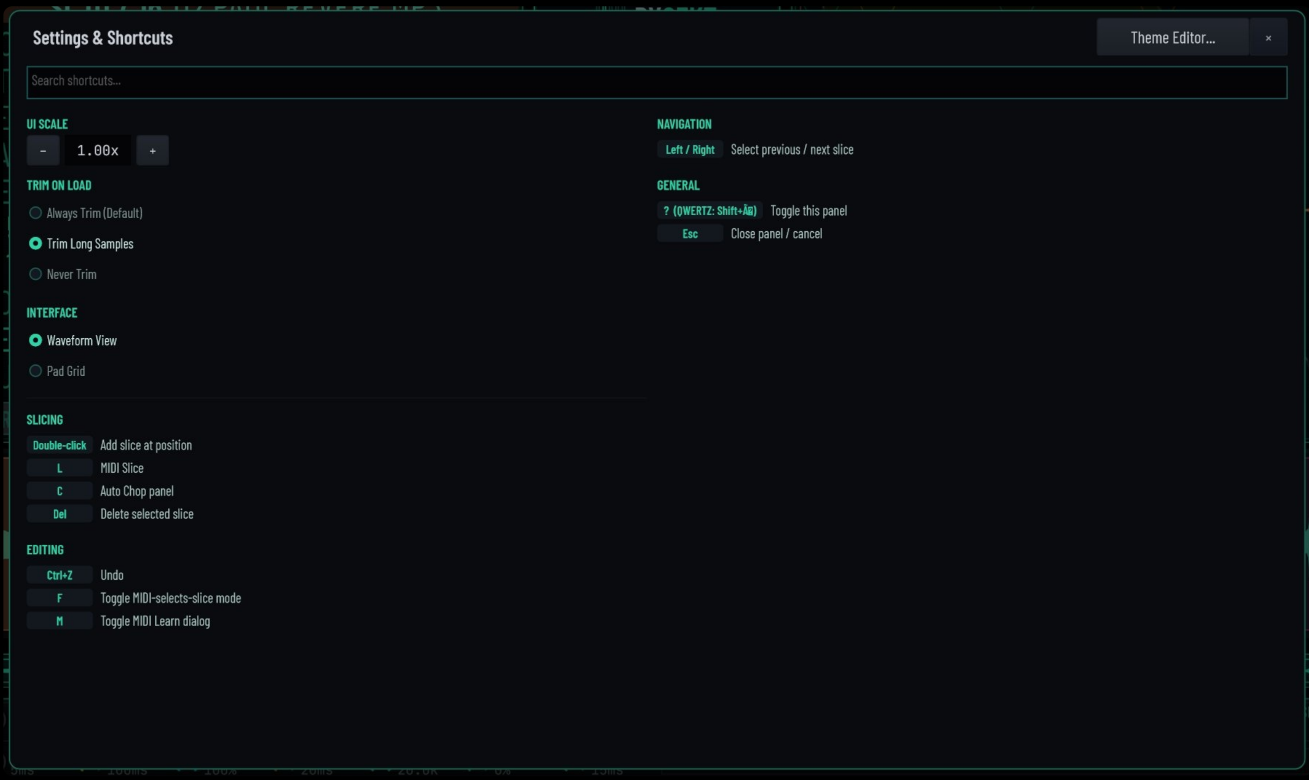
- Switch between built-in themes
- Customize any color (background, accent, slice palette, etc.)
- Save custom themes as `.dsk` files to `%AppData%\DYSEKT\themes\`

UI Scale

The UI scale slider adjusts the overall size of the plugin window. Settings are saved automatically and restored next session.

Keyboard Shortcuts

KEY	ACTION
`?`	Open / close the Shortcuts Panel
`L`	Start / Stop MIDI Slice (live MIDI slicing)
`M`	Open / Close the MIDI Learn dialog
`F`	Toggle MIDI Follow
`Delete`	Delete the currently selected slice
`← →`	Select previous / next slice
`Ctrl` + `Z`	Undo
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z`	Redo
`Esc`	Close the Shortcuts Panel



Undo / Redo / Panic

Undo / Redo covers all slice edits, parameter changes, trims, and slicing operations. Use `Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z`, or the buttons in the interface.

PANIC — the Panic button in the header immediately kills all playing voices and stops all sound. Use it if something gets stuck.

Output Routing

Dysekt supports up to **16 stereo outputs** (Main + Out 2 through Out 16). Your DAW must have multi-output support enabled for the plugin instance.

Assign a slice to any output via:

- The **Output Bus** selector in the Slice Control Bar (Edit View)
- The **output bus selector** on each channel strip in Mixer View

> **EXAMPLE — ABLETON LIVE**
>
> Insert Dysekt on a rack with multi-output enabled. Route kick slices to Output 1, snare to Output 2, everything else to Main. Each output feeds its own channel in your session with its own EQ and compression chain.

Saving Your Work

Dysekt saves its entire state — all slices, parameters, MIDI mappings, and settings — inside your DAW project file automatically. No separate save step needed. When you reopen the project, everything is restored exactly as you left it.

- **MIDI Learn mappings** are saved with the project and also persist independently on disk.
- **Theme and UI scale** settings are saved globally across all projects in `%AppData%\DYSEKT\settings.yaml`.
